

Fund Strategies and Performance

GFGB 8018/ FNGB-74CS

Spring 2026

Email: ltong2@fordham.edu

Class Meeting Time/Location: GFGB-8018-002: Thu 11:00-1:00 @140 West 62nd 214
FNGB-74CS-001: Thu 1:15-3:15 @140 West 62nd 214
GFGB-8018-001: Thu 1:15-3:15 @140 West 62nd 214

Office hours: Zoom Meeting Room (ID 524 685 0402)
By appointment: office (Martino Hall Room 604) or Zoom Meeting Room (ID 524 685 0402)

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course provides students with a comprehensive understanding of the asset management industry in the U.S. It covers key topics in the fund industry, including **quantitative fund trading strategies**, **fund performance evaluation models**, and **ESG investment**. Additionally, the course introduces the application of **machine learning models** in constructing trading strategies. A balance is maintained between empirical models and hands-on programming practice. **Python** is the primary programming language used in the course.

TEXT/MATERIALS

No textbook is required. There will be lecture notes available on Blackboard.

Recommended reading:

Chincarini and Kim (CK), Quantitative Equity Portfolio Management, c2006

Online resources: <https://developers.google.com/edu/python>

SOFTWARE

I will illustrate the programming techniques using Python. Please bring your laptop to each class for programming exercises.

BLACKBOARD

Course materials such as lecture notes, assigned articles, and exam-related materials will be available on the course web page at Blackboard: <https://fordham.blackboard.com/>. Please make sure that you can access this course on Blackboard.

ASSIGNMENTS

There will be approximately **8 individual assignments** and **1 extra credit assignment** throughout the course. **It is required to submit your programs as attachments to each assignment.**

QUIZ

I will give several in-class quiz based on assigned articles.

PRESENTATIONS

Students are expected to form groups of 2–3 people and select one paper from the reading list (available on Blackboard) to present in a 10-minute session during one of our meetings. Each group must email my TA with their group information and a list of three preferred papers from the schedule below. Groups must be formed, and paper selections submitted, by **February 1st**. Priority for paper selection will be given based on the order in which emails are received. An in-class quiz based on the presentation(s) will be administered on the same day for the whole class.

FINAL PROJECT

The final project will be completed in the same groups as the presentations. Students are required to write a term paper based on the knowledge gained in this course and present their findings. Detailed instructions will be provided.

CLASS PARTICIPATION

Attendance at all classes is mandatory, and active participation is strongly encouraged to enhance your learning experience. Attendance will be checked periodically and will partially contribute to your overall attendance grade.

GRADING POLICY

Your final letter grade is awarded based on **your relative ranking** in the class.

Final Project	30%
Paper Presentation	15%
Quiz	15%
Assignments	30%
Class Participation	10%
TOTAL	100%
Extra Credit Assignment	5%

TENTATIVE SCHEDULE

The topics covered on each proposed date may change as the course progresses, but the main content and the general order should not vary.

2026 Spring		
	Date	Topics
1	Thursday, 1/15	L1-Investment management industry overview
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	N/A
	Programming Lab	P0_Python Installation
2	Thursday, 1/22	L2-Quant equity investment intro
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	N/A
	Programming Lab	P1_Python Intro Assignment: HW1
3	Thursday, 1/29	L3-Quant stock selection models-factors
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	N/A
	Programming Lab	P2_Panel data and WRDS Assignment: HW2
4	Thursday, 2/5	L4-Quant stock selection models-demo
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	N/A
	Programming Lab	P3-Factors Assignment: HW3
5	Thursday, 2/12	L4-Quant stock selection models-demo
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	N/A
	Programming Lab	P4-Demo-portfolio Assignment: HW4
6	Thursday, 2/19	L5-More on quant stock selection models + L6-Challenges and Recent Developments
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	N/A
	Programming Lab	WRDS P5-Demo-performance Assignment: HW5
7	Thursday, 2/26	L13-Introduction to Deep Learning
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	1. Empirical Asset Pricing via Machine Learning 2. Returns to Buying Winners and Selling losers 3. Betting Against Beta
	Programming Lab	N/A

8	Thursday, 3/5	L14-Fully connected network and deep learning
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	N/A
	Programming Lab	P6-Demo: Fully connected network Assignment: HW6 (extra credit)
	Thursday, 3/12	No class; Spring Recess
9	Thursday, 3/19	L7-Fund performance evaluation 1
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	N/A
	Programming Lab	P7-Basic performance measures Assignment: HW7
10	Thursday, 3/26	L8-Fund performance evaluation 2
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	4. Investor Inattention and Friday Earnings Announcements. 5. Do investors care about carbon risk?
	Programming Lab	P8-Conditional Performance Evaluation Assignment: HW8
	Thursday, 4/2	No class; Easter Recess
11	Thursday, 4/9	L9-Portfolio Holdings-Based PEVA
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	6. Sex, Drugs, and Bitcoin: How Much Illegal Activity Is Financed through Cryptocurrencies 7. WSJ Category Kings
	Programming Lab	P9 DGTW Assignment: HW9
12	Thursday, 4/16	L10-Measuring Market Timing Skills
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	8. Do Mutual Funds Time the Market? Evidence from Portfolio Holdings 9. Competition in ETF Space
	Programming Lab	N/A
13	Thursday, 4/23	L11-Bootstrapping + L12 Other Topics; Q&A
	Guided Group Discussions and Quiz	N/A
	Programming Lab	N/A
14	Thursday, 4/30	<u>Term paper presentation (1)</u>
15	Thursday, 5/7	<u>Term paper presentation (2)</u>